



Hack-Nation's 4TH GLOBAL AI HACKATHON

in collaboration with MIT Club of Northern California and MIT Club of Germany

Feb. 7 – 8, 2026

Global AI Hackathon – Summary, rules & tips

Deadline: Feb. 8, 9:00 am ET

We are excited that you're part of the Hack-Nation family. Welcome!
To make this experience as fun as possible, please follow the rules below.

1. Choose a challenge and a team

As soon as you're set on a challenge

- If not done yet: Create an account on projects.hack-nation.ai – you have received a personalized login code
- Choose one challenge (from here: [Click here](#)) and let us know in the poll what challenge you'll be tackling. This helps us with planning. No worries, you can still change your challenge if you'd like to

2. Leverage the mentors

If you are stuck and need help, leverage one of our mentors. They are here to help you when you need technical advice!

- Sign-up for a 15 mins mentoring slot on our website projects.hack-nation.ai
- Come prepared with concrete questions

3. Follow the submission guide and deadlines

Deadline: Feb 8, 9:00 am ET

Please submit your projects to both platforms (forms and website)

- Link to form: <https://tinyurl.com/HN-4-submit>
 - Link to project platform: <https://projects.hack-nation.ai/>
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4. Join the Discord for questions

All questions regarding the event and challenges will be answered on Discord

Join here: <https://tinyurl.com/4th-HN-Discord>

5. Apply for API credits

We have a limited number of API credits available.

Request them at <https://projects.hack-nation.ai/>

Global AI Hackathon – Submission Guide

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This is your opportunity to showcase what you built, why it matters, and how it works. The jury will evaluate both the outcome and the clarity of your communication. Submit something simple, functional, and well-explained—even if not everything is perfect.

Rubric:

Technical depth (33%), Creativity & Innovation (33%), Communication (33%)

Submission Checklist

#	Item	Format	Purpose
1	Short description	Text (150–300 words)	High-level pitch for the jury
2	Demo Video	Link (max 60 sec)	Demonstrate your project
3	Tech Video	Link (max 60 sec)	Explain how you built it
4	1-Page Report	PDF	Structured technical summary
5	GitHub Repository	Public link	Source code and documentation
6	Zipped Code	.zip file	Local backup of your project
7	Dataset (if used or generated)	Link or “N/A”	Raw or processed data

+ 1-3 slides and a demo to be shown during the live pitches at 2pm ET, Feb 8

1. Project Summary (150–300 words)

Use this as your elevator pitch to the jury. Focus on clarity and impact.

Include:

- The problem you solved and its relevance
- What you built during the hackathon
- Who benefits from your solution
- What works today and what's impressive about your outcome

Tips:

- Prioritize clarity over technical detail (leave that for the Tech Video)
- Keep it visual and accessible
- This is the first thing the jury will see—make it count

2. Demo Video (60 seconds max)

Goal: Show what your project does—this is your product demo.

Suggested structure:

- 5–10 sec: Introduction to your project and the problem it solves
- 45–50 sec: Screen recording of your tool, app, dashboard, or output
- Optional: Closing result or impact statement

Tips:

- Use Loom, OBS Studio, or Zoom to record
- Add captions or voiceover
- Focus on real functionality and clarity over polish

Not sure how to do that? We have a short video on how to record a video with OBS: [Here](#)

Not sure what to say? Our previous winner Natalie has some tips: [Link](#)

3. Tech Video (60 seconds max)

Goal: Explain how you built your solution and what you learned.

Suggested structure:

1. **Tech Stack Overview (10–15 sec)**
Mention core technologies (e.g., GPT-4, LangChain, Streamlit, Whisper) and how you used them
2. **Implementation Highlights (15–20 sec)**
What part was technically challenging or clever? How did you prioritize and solve it?
3. **Challenges & Limitations (15–20 sec)**
What didn't work at first? What trade-offs or fixes did you apply?
4. **Optional Reflection (5 sec)**
One takeaway or insight from the experience

Tips:

- Speak clearly and conversationally
- Use diagrams or show code briefly if helpful
- Think like a CTO giving a 1-minute investor update

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Not sure what to say? Our previous winner Natalie has some tips: [Link](#)

4. 1-Page Report (PDF)

Purpose:

Provide a structured technical summary to complement your videos.

Required Sections:

1. Problem & Challenge

Describe the specific problem your project addresses. Clearly state the pain point, why it matters, and what is inefficient or broken today. Avoid describing the solution here—focus only on the problem and context.

2. Target Audience

Identify who benefits from your solution. Specify the primary user group and, if relevant, secondary users. Clarify their needs, level of expertise, and why they are affected by the problem.

3. Solution & Core Features

Explain how your solution addresses the problem at a high level. Describe what the system does end-to-end and list the main functionalities that enable this outcome. Keep it functional, not technical.

4. Unique Selling Proposition (USP)

State what differentiates your project from existing solutions. Focus on the key advantage that makes your approach better, faster, simpler, or more scalable, and why that difference matters to users.

5. Implementation & Technology

Summarize how the solution is built from a technical perspective. List the main technologies, models, frameworks, or APIs used and briefly explain their roles. Avoid low-level implementation details.

6. Results & Impact

Describe what you achieved with the project. Highlight measurable outcomes, efficiency gains, or demonstrated value. Focus on impact rather than future plans.

Optional Additions:

- Screenshot or architecture diagram (This does not count towards your page limit)
- Dataset or API references
- One-sentence reflection: "If we had 24 more hours, we'd..."

Format Guidelines:

- Max length: 1 page
- File type: PDF
- Use whitespace, bold headers, and bullet points for clarity
- Include small diagrams only if they support understanding

5. GitHub Repository

Include:

- All project code
- A clear `README.md` with:
 - Project description
 - Setup instructions
 - List of dependencies or environment files

Tips:

- Make the repo public or ensure link access works
- Push your final version before submission

6. Zipped Code File (.zip)

Submit a backup of your full codebase.

Include:

- All files required to run the project
- `README.md`, `requirements.txt`, and setup scripts
- Do not include large data files or model weights

7. Dataset (if applicable)

If you used or generated a dataset:

- Upload to Google Drive, Hugging Face, or similar
 - Organize clearly:
 - `raw/`, `input/`, or `source/`
 - `processed/` or `output/`
 - `README.txt` describing columns or structure
- If not applicable:** Write `N/A` in the form.

Live pitches

- Please use the time after the submission to prepare 1-3 slides and a demo video for a 2 minute pitch
- The top teams are invited to pitch again in front of the jury at 2pm ET Feb. 8.
- Be ready with an elevator pitch

Final Reminders

- Submit everything via the official form AND the projects.hack-nation.ai site before the deadline
- Make sure that all your team members are in the submission - only team members on the submission can receive prizes
- Prioritize a **working MVP and clear explanation** over overambitious scope
- Communicate **creatively and clearly**—focus on what makes your work valuable and usable
- Double check that all video and doc links are set to “publicly accessible by everyone” and the format is appropriate
- No access? No prize.